



“When you know what you want to achieve, you can surely do it”

ADRIAN D'SOUZA HOCKEY PLAYER

I am an idealist for the mere fact that since I was eight or nine-years old, I always dreamt of being in the biggest event any sportsman could play, the Olympics. When I turned 20, I was there and that's one time when I realised that yes, I can make a difference. If I dream big, I can surely do it. But at the same time one has to be real. I also dreamt of winning medals, definitely winning the gold in the Olympics when I grew older. When I played for the Indian national team, I knew it's not easy. Being the goalkeeper of the national hockey team is not a piece of cake. But I know that someday, if I work harder, if we work harder as a team, we can achieve our goals. If I have to say something for the youth, it's very important to have an ideal mind because no matter what, but as long as you have the same thinking towards life and what you want to achieve in life, you can achieve whatever you want. I want to say this again and again that never ever give up because we live just once and it's important to be an idealist.

women can be at the heart of knocking a host of our development issues from population to health, to the environment.

If we can give young women the means, the skills and the confidence to change their own environments, we may actually strengthen the movement where people can find local solutions to development challenges much better than we can figure it out ourselves. So a large part of my motivation to move to India was to set the seeds for an institution that focuses on girls' education and leadership.

My hope for our generation is that we do well and we prosper. Not just accumulate more for ourselves, but to expand the opportunities for others. We have to lift as we climb. Harder than waiting until 2050—whatever arbitrary date in the future—is to tackle the hard questions which actually is what a lot of countries do. We can learn from the mistakes that others have made. We have to be up for the task while we are still young because it is now our watch.

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DISCUSSION

Q. Can you change the cancers in India's systems—of education, police, health—and with it the caste system?

Deepender S. Hooda: The days of divisive politics in India are over. Governments are getting voted back in power because of governance, not because of caste or religion. In my first term, I contested and was elected. As a product of the system, I won by a margin of 2.25 lakh votes. I won the second election by a margin of 4.5 lakh votes from areas in my constituency where there was not even a single voter from my caste. I got elected. I am proud of it. I want to live with that hope.

Q. The Shiv Sena and MNS are big bullies. The ideal is that Bollywood should stand up as one but in reality many of you did not utter a single word in support of

Shah Rukh Khan.

Ranbir Kapoor: I don't think you need any vocalisation of support when you support someone. I faced a similar situation while releasing *Wake Up Sid*. We had used the word Bombay in the film a lot and so the MNS opposed it and asked us to use the word Mumbai instead. Yes, it is bullying. I don't know how it can be stopped. I am too small a person to stand up against such a big power... I don't think Shah Rukh Khan was bogged down or apologised to anybody. He was absolutely right in his belief.

Q. Do you ever feel that you should have chosen cricket and not hockey?

Adrian D'Souza: I don't think I have made a mistake by taking up hockey. I love this game. I never played cricket in my school. Cricket

is the most popular sport that everybody follows. I am sure many of you don't even know the eleven players of the Indian hockey team. We used to wonder why is it that we are treated this way? We discussed that we needed to fight against the system. Eventually, it turned into reality. We went on a strike for a day. There was a change and we could feel it. If we have unity and if we all want to achieve the same goal, we can turn idealism into reality.

Q. What are the two most important things to realise the idealism of having India in the top three economies of the world?

Roopa Purushothaman: Education and infrastructure. We have this huge, young labour force, half the population under the age of 26, but not huge if it doesn't participate. If we kept our participation rights

similar to what we have right now, by 2030, we are going to look more like Japan. We are just going to be supporting so many people who just don't work. We have got to figure out this way of extracting the government from being involved in every sort of aspect of trying to take care of things and not doing it all.

Q. What is it about the Indian business system that those who do not belong to legacies cannot rise?

Tanya A. Dubash: Many of us, of age old family business learned how to work with the old system where there was rampant corruption. To succeed 30 years ago was far more difficult than it is today where there is a lot of opportunity to be idealistic, to grow with integrity. A slow cleaning up of the economic and political system will facilitate it.